

Oceanography MSc Thesis Grading Rubric (v. 2026.08.20)

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criterion	Excellent (1.0)	Very Good/ Good (1.3–1.7)	Good (2.0–2.3)	Satisfactory (2.7–3.3)	Sufficient (3.7–4.0)	Fail (5.0)
Overall Quality	Outstanding thesis demonstrating talent for research or original perspective	Very good thesis that is clearly and positively distinguishable	A good thesis	A satisfactory thesis	Acceptable thesis satisfying minimum criteria	Does not satisfy minimum requirements
Theoretical Knowledge & Methods	• Very good insight into scientific theory and methods + demonstrated scientific knowledge at very high level • Well-defined, easy to understand objectives	• Very good scientific knowledge and insight • Well-defined, easy to understand objectives	• Quite good scientific knowledge and insight • Generally well-defined objectives but may contain some inexact formulations	• Good scientific knowledge • Defined objectives but may contain inexact formulations	• Sufficient scientific knowledge • Objectives described but vague and imprecise	• Does not have sufficient scientific knowledge and insight • Objectives not clearly defined or lacking
Technical Skills & Independence	• Selects and applies relevant methods convincingly • All technical skills required • Plans and conducts very advanced experiments / computations without help • Works very independently	• Selects and applies relevant methods soundly • Almost all technical skills required • Plans and conducts advanced experiments / computations without help • Works very independently	• Uses relevant methods satisfactorily • Most technical skills required • Plans and conducts quite advanced experiments/computations without help • Works independently	• Generally able to apply relevant methods • Main technical skills required • Plans and conducts experiments/computations without help • Works independently to some extent but needs quite close supervision	• Able to apply some relevant methods • Minimum technical skills required • Plans and conducts simple experiments/computations without help • Achieves limited progress without close supervision • Has problems utilizing research group expertise	• Demonstrates lack of competence in scientific methods • Does not have required technical skills and independence • Has scarcely utilized research group expertise

Assessment Criterion	Excellent (1.0)	Very Good/ Good (1.3–1.7)	Good (2.0–2.3)	Satisfactory (2.7–3.3)	Sufficient (3.7–4.0)	Fail (5.0)
Research Quality & Analysis	• Very extensive and/or innovative • Extremely good scientific foundation and justification • Clearly linked to topic • Extremely good critical reflection • Clearly distinguishes own contributions from others	• Extensive and/or innovative • Very good scientific foundation and justification • Clearly linked to topic • Very good critical reflection • Clearly distinguishes own contributions from others	• Good with creative elements • Good scientific foundation and justification • Linked to topic • Good critical reflection • Usually distinguishes clearly between own and others' contributions	• Satisfactory scientific foundation and justification • Linked to topic but room for improvement • Demonstrates ability for critical reflection but has problems distinguishing own contributions from others	• Limited and somewhat fragmented • Adequate scientific foundation and justification but ought to have better link to topic • Sufficient critical reflection but may have problems distinguishing contributions	• Very limited and fragmented • Analysis and discussion do not have adequate scientific foundation and justification • Loosely linked • Does not demonstrate sufficient critical reflection • Does not clearly distinguish between contributions
Presentation Quality	Form, structure and language at extremely high level	Form, structure and language at very high level	Form, structure and language at good level	Form, structure and language at acceptable level	Mostly acceptable but has definite shortcomings with respect to form, structure and language	Major shortcomings with respect to form, structure and language

Usage Notes

Each criterion should be evaluated independently, though the final grade represents an overall assessment.

1. **Overall Quality:** General evaluation of the thesis
2. **Theoretical Knowledge & Methods:** Understanding of scientific theory, methodology, and objective setting
3. **Technical Skills & Independence:** Ability to apply methods, technical competence, and level of independence
4. **Research Quality & Analysis:** Extent and quality of research, analysis depth, and critical thinking
5. **Presentation Quality:** Writing quality, structure, and communication effectiveness

When grading, consider the predominant level of performance across criteria, while noting that a thesis may show variation across different assessment areas.